

Lab: Strategic Assumption Audit

Objectives

Learning Goal: Surface, categorize, and stress-test the implicit beliefs driving your organization's strategy.

Part 1: Elicit Assumptions (15 min)

List the top 8–10 beliefs your organization holds about its environment:

#	Assumption	Category (Customer/Market/Competitor/ Capability/Causal)	Strength (1–5)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Write your response here

Part 2: Classify (10 min)

For each assumption, classify along two dimensions:

Assumption #	Critical to strategy? (Y/N)	Testable? (Y/N)	Priority (Critical+Testable = HIGH)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Write your response here

Part 3: Challenge (15 min)

For the top 3 highest-priority assumptions, answer:

Assumption 1: _____

Question	Answer
What evidence supports this?	
What evidence contradicts this?	
What would change your mind?	
When was this assumption last tested?	
What is the cost if this assumption is wrong?	

Assumption 2: _____

Question	Answer
What evidence supports this?	
What evidence contradicts this?	
What would change your mind?	
When was this assumption last tested?	
What is the cost if this assumption is wrong?	

Assumption 3: _____

Question	Answer
What evidence supports this?	
What evidence contradicts this?	
What would change your mind?	
When was this assumption last tested?	
What is the cost if this assumption is wrong?	

Write your response here

Part 4: Design Tests (15 min)

For each challenged assumption, design a test:

Assumption	Test Design (experiment, research, analysis)	Timeline	Cost	Success Criteria

Write your response here

Part 5: Synthesis

Finding	Detail
Most dangerous assumption (high impact, weak evidence)	
Most urgently testable assumption	
Assumption the organization is most resistant to questioning	
Recommended next step	